



Workshop reflection report

Workshop Title: Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry

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Course Title: EN8914 - CL Project

Date: 9th October 2025

Time: 4:00pm – 6:00pm

Platform: Microsoft Teams

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Organizer: Bahrain Polytechnic

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Introduction

Impactful Leadership in Engineering is an interactive professional development workshop designed to enhance the leadership capabilities of engineers and technical professionals and create a leadership community capable of development, creativity, innovation, and achievement. The workshop focuses on defining engineering leadership and leadership in general, then links the two concepts together. It also focuses on equipping participants with essential skills, such as communication, teamwork, adaptability, and ethical decision-making, to enhance their technical expertise. The workshop highlights the role of effective leadership in stimulating innovation, improving team performance, and ensuring responsible engineering practices that contribute to the success of the individual, the team, the organization, and sustainable development.

Main Points and Scope

The "Impactful Leadership in Engineering" workshop provided a comprehensive and distinctive explanation of the concepts of engineering leadership and leadership in general, and the interrelationship between them. It also provided a comprehensive overview of the importance of leadership and the fundamental leadership principles that shape successful engineering practices. The workshop also clearly demonstrated the difference between leadership and management and highlighted the roles of each. Designed to enhance technical and interactive capabilities, the workshop focused on equipping participants with the skills necessary to lead teams, managing innovation, and promoting ethical decision-making, focusing on individuals in complex technical environments. Its primary objective was to clarify the role of impactful leadership as a catalyst for creativity, project success, achievement, and continuous professional growth and development in the engineering field.

The workshop addressed the intersection of engineering expertise and leadership effectiveness, emphasizing that technical excellence alone is not sufficient without strong communication, integrity, and emotional awareness.

The workshop focused on the following main key points

- **Understanding Leadership and Engineering Leadership**

Leadership is the ability to inspire, influence, and guide others toward common

goals. Engineering leadership applies these same principles within technical and problem-solving contexts, combining analytical thinking, collaboration, ethics, and innovation.

- **Leadership Beyond Titles**

True leadership is not defined by position but by the ability to inspire change, empower others, and transform visions into reality through courage and action.

- **Essential Engineering Leadership Skills**

Effective leaders balance technical expertise, business acumen, and interpersonal skills using communication, decision-making, and emotional intelligence to motivate teams and achieve organizational success.

- **The Role of Self-Leadership**

Leadership begins with leading oneself. A great leader is first a learner developing self-awareness and experience before teaching and guiding others.

- **Building Trust Through Character, Competence, and Connection**

Trust is the foundation of leadership and is built through integrity, skill, and empathy. Ethical behavior and genuine relationships create loyal, motivated teams.

- **The Six Leadership Mindsets**

Effective leadership integrates six mindsets: reflective, collaborative, creative and critical thinking, responsible action, gender equality, and worldly. Together, they form the foundation of impactful leadership.

The Most Important Things That I Have Learnt

Throughout the Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop, I gained a deep understanding of leadership from both general and engineering perspectives. I learned that leadership in general is the ability to inspire, influence, and guide individuals toward common goals through a clear vision, integrity, and effective communication. Leadership in engineering, however, builds upon these same principles but operates within a highly technical and problem-solving environment. It requires balancing analytical thinking with human-centered management, applying empathy, ethical responsibility, and innovation to lead technical teams and create sustainable engineering solutions.

One of the most valuable lessons I learned is that leadership is not defined by position or title, but by one's ability to empower, influence, and inspire others to create positive change. True leaders make a difference not through authority but through courage, vision, and action; they dream of a better future and work persistently to make it a reality.

The workshop also emphasized the core skills and qualities of effective engineering leadership, which include a combination of technical expertise, business acumen, and interpersonal capabilities. Engineering leaders must understand complex technical problems while managing resources, aligning projects with organizational objectives, and fostering innovation. Equally essential are leadership skills such as communication, emotional intelligence, and ethical decision-making, all of which help build strong, motivated, and collaborative teams.

Another key takeaway was the importance of self-leadership, which forms the foundation of all successful leadership. The workshop highlighted that a great leader begins by leading themselves, embracing continuous learning, reflection, and personal growth. A true leader is first a learner, and only then a teacher who shares knowledge and inspires others.

I also learned that building trust is the cornerstone of effective leadership. Trust is developed through the balance of character, competence, and connection, each supported by ethics and honesty. Character reflects integrity and consistency between words and actions, competence demonstrates reliability and expertise, and connection fosters empathy and respect. When these elements align, leaders create environments of confidence, collaboration, and loyalty, where people feel valued and empowered to achieve shared goals.

Finally, the workshop introduced the concept that effective leadership is shaped by multiple mindsets. These include a reflective mindset that promotes self-awareness and growth, a collaborative mindset that strengthens teamwork and respect, and a creative and critical

thinking mindset that drives innovation and adaptability. A responsible action mindset ensures ethical and purposeful decisions, while a gender equality mindset promotes inclusivity and fairness. A worldly mindset encourages global awareness and cultural sensitivity. Together, these mindsets form a holistic approach to leadership, reminding us that a leader must inspire, or their team will expire emphasizing that true leadership lies not in authority, but in the ability to motivate, empower, and ignite passion in others.

New Aspects and Techniques Presented

The Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop introduced several new aspects and innovative techniques that redefined my understanding of what it means to be an effective and impactful leader in the engineering field. It went beyond the traditional view of leadership as authority or management, presenting a multidimensional and human-centered perspective that integrates technical excellence with emotional intelligence, ethics, and adaptability.

One of the key new aspects introduced was the distinction between general leadership and engineering leadership. While general leadership focuses on inspiring and guiding others toward shared goals through vision, communication, and integrity, engineering leadership extends these principles into a more technical and problem-solving environment. This concept highlighted how modern engineers must combine analytical thinking with empathy and ethical responsibility to lead innovation effectively and sustainably.

Another significant aspect presented in the workshop was the concept that leadership is not defined by position or title. This technique encourages participants to view leadership as a mindset and behavior rather than a role. It taught that anyone, regardless of their formal position, can demonstrate leadership by influencing, inspiring, and creating a positive impact within their team or organization. This approach promotes empowerment, self-motivation, and proactive engagement among all team members.

The workshop also introduced a structured framework for effective engineering leadership skills, combining three essential dimensions:

- **Technical expertise** – the foundation for understanding complex engineering challenges and guiding teams effectively.
- **Business acumen** – aligning projects with organizational goals, managing resources, and fostering innovation.

- **Interpersonal and leadership skills** – including communication, decision-making, and emotional intelligence, which drive collaboration and team cohesion.

This integrative model provides a clear roadmap for developing well-rounded engineering leaders who are both technically competent and emotionally intelligent.

A particularly valuable new concept was the importance of self-leadership, the understanding that effective leadership begins with leading oneself. This idea emphasizes continuous learning, reflection, and self-improvement as the foundation for guiding others. The principle that “a leader is a learner first, then a teacher” reinforced the idea that personal growth and humility are prerequisites for sustainable leadership success.

Additionally, the workshop introduced the “Three Pillars of Trust” character, competence, and connection as a new technique for building strong and reliable relationships within teams. Character ensures integrity and consistency, competence demonstrates reliability and expertise, and connection builds empathy and respect. When balanced, these elements create a culture of trust that strengthens collaboration and commitment to shared goals.

The workshop also presented a multi-mindset leadership model as a modern approach to leadership development. This includes several mindsets:

- **Reflective mindset** – fostering self-awareness and lifelong learning.
- **Collaborative mindset** – emphasizing teamwork, mutual respect, and inclusion.
- **Creative and critical thinking mindset** – driving innovation and adaptive problem-solving.
- **Responsible action mindset** – ensuring that decisions are ethical and socially responsible.
- **Gender equality mindset** – promoting inclusivity and equal opportunity in leadership.
- **Worldly mindset** – encouraging global awareness and cultural sensitivity in leadership practice.

In addition, the workshop was presented using a unique and interactive technique based on open dialogue between the presenter and participants. It felt like an engaging discussion session in which ideas, experiences, and diverse perspectives were exchanged freely, adding significant value to everyone involved. Furthermore, a creative method was used to deliver the content the facilitator supported key messages with inspiring quotes and real

stories from renowned and distinguished leaders who serve as role models in the field of leadership. These stories brought the concepts to life, showing how theory can be transformed into practice and motivating participants to follow in the footsteps of exemplary leaders.

Together, these new aspects and techniques expanded my understanding of leadership and provided practical strategies to apply not only in engineering projects but also in professional and personal growth. The workshop successfully blended knowledge, inspiration, and interaction, making it both intellectually stimulating and deeply motivating.

Application of Workshop Aspects and Techniques to Projects

Applying the Workshop's Aspects and Techniques in General

The Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop emphasized that leadership in engineering combines technical competence with human-centered management. The aspects and techniques presented can be applied to any project to improve teamwork, communication, and overall performance.

In any engineering project, understanding leadership beyond position or title is fundamental. Leadership is about the ability to inspire, influence, and guide others toward achieving shared objectives. Applying this concept means that every team member can take initiative, show responsibility, and contribute positively to the success of the project.

The workshop also emphasized the importance of self-leadership as the foundation of all effective leadership. A leader must first learn, reflect, and develop personal discipline before leading others. This principle encourages continuous learning, improvement, and accountability in any project environment.

Another key technique that can be applied universally is building trust through character, competence, and connection. Character ensures integrity and honesty, competence reflects the ability to deliver results, and connection strengthens teamwork through empathy and respect. Together, these elements create an atmosphere of collaboration and shared purpose in project work.

Moreover, by applying essential leadership mindsets, reflective, collaborative, creative, and critical thinking, as well as responsible action, gender equality, and worldly perspectives—leaders can balance self-awareness, teamwork, innovation, ethics, inclusivity, and global

understanding in their projects. These mindsets collectively support the development of impactful leadership within any engineering or technical setting.

Applying the Workshop's Aspects and Techniques to My Project

The Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop provided valuable leadership principles that I can effectively apply to my project, SmartGuard, an intelligent child safety and monitoring system designed to prevent incidents of children being unintentionally left in vehicles. The workshop emphasized that leadership is not defined by a position or title, but by the ability to influence, inspire, and create a positive impact, an approach that directly supports the teamwork, creativity, and sense of shared responsibility required in the SmartGuard project. By applying the workshop's aspects, I can demonstrate leadership beyond formal roles by taking initiative, maintaining accountability for the project's success, and motivating my team through a clear vision centered on safety, innovation, and ethical responsibility. Moreover, the workshop's focus on self-leadership serves as a continuous reminder to lead by example, remain adaptable, and commit to lifelong learning. This principle encourages me to reflect regularly on both my technical and personal development, ensuring that my leadership within the SmartGuard project contributes not only to technical excellence but also to a collaborative, responsible, and value-driven engineering culture.

Applying the concept of engineering leadership, I can balance technical expertise with human-centered management throughout the project. This means combining analytical and problem-solving abilities with collaboration, communication, and ethical responsibility. By doing so, I can ensure that every team member, whether focusing on AI programming, sensor integration, or system design, feels valued, motivated, and aligned with the shared vision of protecting children's lives through technology.

The workshop's emphasis on self-leadership serves as a guiding principle in my role within the project. Leading by example, maintaining self-discipline, and continuous learning will allow me to support my team effectively and handle challenges with confidence and adaptability. As the workshop highlighted, a true leader is a learner first, and this mindset will help me foster a culture of learning and innovation within the SmartGuard team.

Another key lesson applied to my project is the importance of building trust through character, competence, and connection. Trust will be built by demonstrating integrity and consistency between words and actions, ensuring the reliability and accuracy of the

SmartGuard system through technical competence, and strengthening the bond among team members through open communication and mutual respect. These elements are essential for ensuring the project's credibility and for delivering a system that parents, schools, and society can rely on.

Finally, I can apply the leadership mindsets introduced in the workshop to enhance the success of my project. A reflective mindset will guide me in continuously evaluating progress and learning from challenges, while a collaborative mindset will strengthen teamwork, communication, and shared responsibility among the project members. A creative and critical thinking mindset will inspire innovative approaches to developing the SmartGuard system, and a responsible action mindset will ensure that all decisions and designs remain ethical, safe, and purposeful. Moreover, a worldly mindset allows me to view SmartGuard as more than a technical solution; it is a contribution to global well-being that directly supports Sustainable Development Goal 3 (Good Health and Well-Being) by preventing child fatalities and promoting safety in transportation.

Beyond SDG 3, the SmartGuard project also aligns with several other United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). It supports SDG 9 (Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure) by utilizing advanced IoT and AI technologies to promote innovation in safety systems, and SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities) by improving the safety, reliability, and inclusiveness of school transportation. Furthermore, it contributes to SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production) through its energy-efficient and sustainable system design, and to SDG 16 (Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions) by ensuring transparency, accountability, and ethical data management. Through these connections, the SmartGuard project demonstrates how the principles of impactful leadership and sustainable engineering can work together to create technology that not only solves real-world problems but also advances social responsibility and global well-being.

In summary, by integrating these workshop aspects into the SmartGuard project, I can ensure that the team not only achieves technical success but also upholds the values of ethical responsibility, collaboration, and empathy, core principles of impactful engineering leadership.

Suggestions for Improvement

While the Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop was highly informative and inspiring, several enhancements could further strengthen its impact and better support both project development and future professional growth.

One potential improvement would be to incorporate more engineering-based case studies and real-world examples that demonstrate how leadership decisions directly influence technical innovation, ethical responsibility, and project success. Examining leadership challenges from actual engineering projects, especially those involving safety systems or emerging technologies, would help bridge theory and practice more effectively.

Furthermore, the workshop could include a segment on digital communication and remote leadership, exploring how leaders can effectively manage virtual or hybrid teams. As modern engineering projects often involve remote collaboration, learning how to communicate, motivate, and coordinate teams through digital platforms would be extremely valuable for future professional practice.

Additionally, the workshop could benefit from interactive project-based activities or simulations that allow participants to apply leadership principles in realistic engineering contexts. For instance, engaging in group exercises where participants assume leadership roles to solve a technical or ethical problem would reinforce teamwork, communication, and decision-making skills that are vital to managing complex projects like SmartGuard.

Another valuable improvement for the Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop would be the inclusion of a personal leadership assessment tool or diagnostic activity. This would allow participants to evaluate their current leadership style, strengths, and areas for development before and after the workshop. Such a self-assessment would make the learning experience more personalized and measurable, helping participants set concrete goals for improvement in their academic and project work.

It would also be valuable to add a segment on technological leadership and innovation management, focusing on how leadership principles apply in areas such as IoT systems, artificial intelligence, and sustainable engineering. This addition would provide deeper insight into leading multidisciplinary, technology-driven projects and align directly with the needs of future engineering leaders.

The workshop could also benefit from including discussions or guest talks by practicing engineering leaders. Hearing firsthand experiences from industry professionals who have

successfully applied leadership in technical contexts would offer practical guidance and inspiration for participants preparing to enter the workforce.

Another possible improvement would be to include a section on emotional resilience and stress management in leadership. Engineering projects often involve tight deadlines and high-pressure decision-making and understanding how to lead calmly and maintain team morale under stress would be a practical skill for participants to develop.

Moreover, offering certification or recognition of leadership participation and achievement could serve as a motivating factor for students. A recognized certificate, portfolio entry, or leadership badge could add professional value to participants' academic records and encourage continuous engagement with leadership learning.

Finally, incorporating follow-up mentorship or guidance sessions after the workshop could help participants continue developing their leadership competencies and apply the learned concepts to their academic or professional projects. This continued support would be particularly beneficial for projects like SmartGuard, which require sustained collaboration, ethical awareness, and innovation. Overall, by integrating practical, technology-oriented, and mentorship-based elements, the workshop could further empower participants to translate impactful leadership into meaningful engineering solutions and long-term career success.

Conclusion

In conclusion, attending the Impactful Leadership for the Engineering Industry workshop was a transformative learning experience that expanded my understanding of what true leadership means within technical and professional contexts. The workshop deepened my awareness that impactful leadership is not defined by authority or title, but by the ability to inspire, influence, and empower others toward a shared vision. It also reinforced the importance of balancing technical expertise with emotional intelligence, communication, and ethical responsibility, qualities essential for every successful engineering leader.

Through this workshop, I learned how leadership mindsets such as reflection, collaboration, creativity, responsibility, and global awareness can be applied to enhance innovation and teamwork in engineering projects. These lessons have directly influenced how I approach my project, SmartGuard, by guiding me to lead with empathy, adaptability, and integrity while maintaining a strong focus on safety and social responsibility.

Overall, the workshop has not only strengthened my leadership skills but also shaped my perspective on engineering as a field that connects technology with humanity. It has

inspired me to continue developing as a self-aware, ethical, and innovative leader who contributes to sustainable and meaningful change both within my projects and throughout my future professional career.